

CRY INTERNSHIP REPORT

SUBMITTED BY

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My internship with CRY was an enriching experience which improved my leadership, communication and problem-solving skills. I was assigned the role of a peer mentor in the Youth Champions (YCC) program, which is an educational internship program for school-going students studying in grades 9-12. Our mentor for this program was Mrs. Monisha Murali, who acted as an excellent guide for us throughout the program by responding to our queries and doubts and helping us at every step of this program. During the internship, I got to interact with many budding change champions who were very much active in the program, and I enjoyed working with them and clearing their doubts and listening to their insightful suggestions on the program.

As part of the internship, I got the opportunity to visit the Government Urdu Lower Primary School in Geddalahalli, Bengaluru. Interacting with the school's students was a memorable experience. They all participated in all the activities and games we had planned with great enthusiasm, and their energy was contagious, which made the visit both meaningful and enjoyable. The students interacted warmly with me and my fellow interns, and I'm very happy that I could be a part of the school visit.

Government school in Bengaluru, Karnataka vs Government school in Ernakulam, Kerala - A comparative school report

Since I had the opportunity to visit a government school in Bengaluru during the internship, I wanted to reflect on that experience by writing a comparative, holistic report. This report compares the Government Urdu Lower Primary School (GLUPS) in Geddalahalli, Bengaluru, which we visited as part of the internship, with a government school in my hometown, the Government Lower Primary School (GLPS) Cheranalloor, situated in Ernakulam district, Kerala.

The visit to Government Lower Urdu Primary School, Geddalahalli, was one of the most memorable parts of my internship. What stood out the most were the young children who were always full of energy, curiosity, and excitement. Their enthusiasm in participating in our planned activities made the visit truly enjoyable. The school had a small courtyard, which served both as a morning assembly ground and as a playground for the students. The midday meal scheme was being implemented properly; we observed children helping with bringing in the food containers, and it felt good to see that sense of responsibility among them. The classrooms were slightly smaller in size compared to the number of students present, but they were equipped with the necessary facilities. There was a consistent electricity supply, blackboards in use, and seating benches, although the benches were short and almost floor-level, they were functional. We also got to observe how the teachers managed the classroom. Their approach to discipline was firm, occasionally involving methods like

tapping a wooden stick on the table to maintain silence or asking students to stand outside the class for misbehaving in the class. While these methods may appear strict, they seemed to be the school's everyday culture of maintaining classroom order. The medium of instruction was mainly Kannada and Urdu. The children were mostly multilingual, with them being able to speak Kannada and Hindi, along with learning Urdu. The school has students from 1st to 7th grade.

Government Lower Primary School (GLPS) Cheranalloor, located in Ernakulam district, shares several similarities with GLUPS Geddalahalli in Bengaluru. It is also a co-educational government school that offers basic facilities such as regular classroom instruction, a functioning midday meal scheme, and constant electricity supply. The classrooms are well-maintained and provide a suitable learning environment for primary students. However, what sets GLPS Cheranalloor apart is the availability of additional resources that improve the learning experience for students. The school has a library with 500+ books, promoting reading habits among children. There is also a computer room, primarily used by teachers. The school features a large playground along with a small auditorium close by, giving students enough space for play, movement, and school-level events. Drinking water facilities are also available for the students. The medium of instruction is Malayalam, and the school caters to students from Grades 1 to 4. With nine teachers, including the headmistress, the school maintains a healthy student-to-teacher ratio, which supports more focused teaching and individual attention.

To conclude the comparison helped me understand the similarities and differences in how government schools function across the states of Karnataka and Kerala, though it is not intended to be a comprehensive review of school infrastructure in both states. Both GLUPS Geddalahalli and GLPS Cheranalloor offer the essential elements of schooling: dedicated teachers, functioning classrooms, electricity, and midday meals. The school in Kerala, however, benefits from a few additional facilities such as a library, a computer room, and a larger space for outdoor activities. What stood out to me the most was that, despite differences in infrastructure, both schools foster positive and encouraging learning environments. The students in both places were equally eager to learn, curious, and full of energy. They each had their own dreams and potential, reminding me that every child, regardless of their background, deserves the opportunity to grow in a safe and supportive school space.

I sincerely appreciate CRY providing me the chance to participate in this internship. I was able to make a significant contribution and gain knowledge from practical experiences on the ground. The opportunity to collaborate with young changemakers made this internship memorable.